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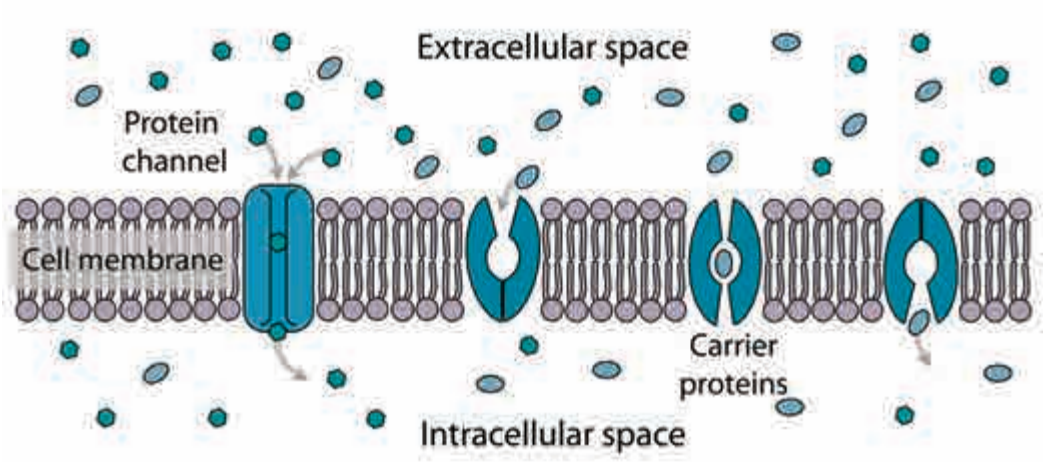


Figure 6.13: Transport of molecules through cell membrane

Function of Cell Membrane

The functions of the cell membrane is enormous which includes cell signalling, transporting nutrients and water, preventing unwanted substances entering into the cell, and so on.

Cell Transport

Cell membrane act as a channel of transport for molecules. The membrane is selectively permeable to molecules. It transports molecules through energy dependant process and energy independent process. The membrane proteins (channel and carrier) are involved in movement of ions and molecules across the membrane (Figure 6.13).

Endocytosis and Exocytosis

Cell surface membrane are able to transport individual molecules and ions. There are processes in which a cell can transport a large quantity of solids and liquids into cell (**endocytosis**) or out of cell (**exocytosis**) (Figure 6.14).

Endocytosis: During endocytosis the cell wraps the cell surface membrane around the material and brings it into

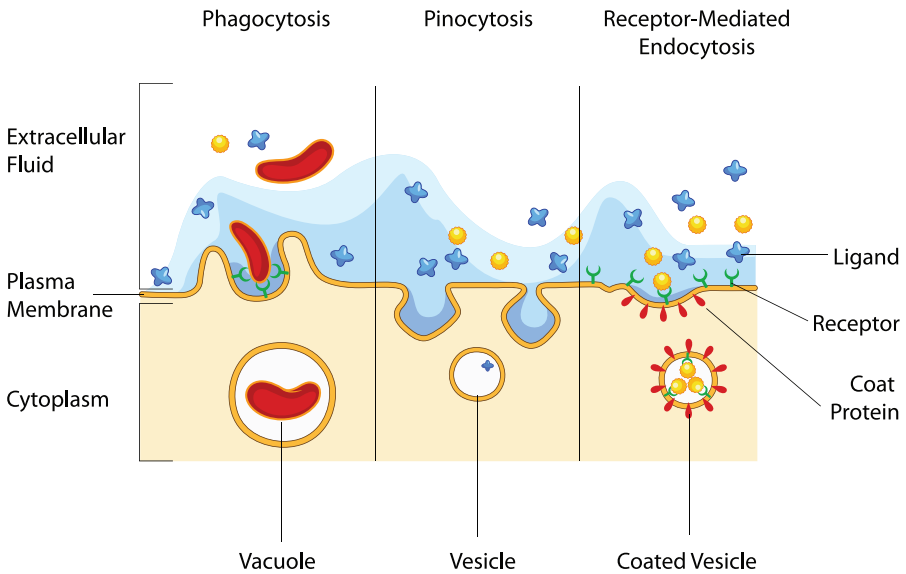


Figure 6.14: Endocytosis and exocytosis